FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-28-25002

Issue Title : Defuel Tube Cracks

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2800-00	-10, -7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/28/2025	09/01/2026	08/04/2026
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	
03/31/2027	11/27/2026	

Revision Description

Updated Final Action & Milestone dates.

Description

Boeing has received multiple reports of uncommanded center tank to right main tank fuel transfer during flight and reports of a fuel leak out of the right main wing surge tank during taxi or departure. Upon investigation, operators have discovered a cracked defuel tube located in the right main tank. The cracked defuel tube can allow fuel transfer from the center tank to the right main tank when the right center tank override pump is turned on. Damage conditions have included: bents, cracks, fractures, kinks, and wrinkles. The Boeing safety process determined this issue to be “Not Safety”.

Status

The root cause of the cracking has not been determined. However, Boeing has decided to move forward with a solution that would encompass any possible root cause(s). The redesign will replace 3 tubes with 2 tubes (see redesign concept attached). This has the benefit of utilizing the existing clamps to support all tubes, as well as prevents the situation where one unsupported tube can rotate and allow loads to be imposed that otherwise wouldn’t be there. Additionally, this will will also reduce bend angle where cracking occurs.

Interim Action

Operators should monitor for uncommanded fuel tank-to tank transfer, fuel imbalance, and fuel spill events. When evaluating these events, consider a faulted defuel tube as a potential root cause if fuel is being transferred into the right main tank uncommanded.

Boeing recommends operator use the updated fault isolation manual (FIM) 28-21 to check for a cracked defuel tube during an uncommanded center-to-right main tank fuel transfer.

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Final Action

Production Solution:

Release the new tube design engineering into the production system.

Retrofit Solution:

Operators are required to complete SB 737-28-1376, primed clip-on nuts, prior to performing the cracked defuel tube retrofit service bulletin.

Note: For more information regarding SB 737-28-1376, please refer to 737MAX-FTD-28-22002.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Solution Selected: Completed

Defuel Tube Certification Approval: October 2026 (target)
Production Incorporation on LN 10062: November 2026 (target)

MAX Retrofit Service Bulletin Available: Q1 2027 (target)
Parts Available: TBD

Related Categories

- Significant Technical Flight Interruptions : Issues that cause in-flight events such as rejected takeoffs, air turnbacks, diversions, emergency landings, in-flight shutdowns, and abnormal stops

Attachments:

a) Defuel Tube Redesign

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